Exp 7: Integrating a Zoho Creator Application with Another Zoho Service using Connections and APIs

1. Aim

To integrate the **Loan Application & Pre-Screening Management** application with Bigin by Zoho CRM or Zoho CRM using a protected Zoho Creator connection and a post-submission Deluge workflow. The integration creates a controlled CRM lead or enquiry record after a valid **Loan_Application_Form** submission.

2. Procedure

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Phase A: Open the Microservices Workspace

Step 1: In the loan application workspace, open **Microservices** from the development navigation and select **Create New**.

Step 2: In the microservice palette, choose **Connections** to configure a reusable authenticated link to another Zoho service.

Phase B: Configure the Zoho CRM Connection

Step 3: Select Bigin by Zoho CRM or Zoho CRM from the built-in connector catalog.

Step 4: Give the connection a clear link name such as **loan_crm_connection**. Restrict authorization and connection management to administrators.

Step 5: Request only the scopes required to create or update the selected CRM module. Avoid “all actions” or “all modules” when narrower scopes are supported.

Phase C: Protect Applicant Data

Step 6: Define the minimum field mapping before writing the workflow. Send contact and enquiry-routing details required by the CRM; keep PAN_Number, Date_Of_Birth, Residential_Address, Monthly_Income, Existing_Liabilities, and Consent_For_Credit_Check out of the payload unless an approved business process specifically requires them.

Phase D: Configure the Submission Workflow

Step 7: Under **Workflow > Form workflows**, create an action for Loan_Application_Form after successful record creation.

Step 8: Build a CRM payload from Applicant_Name, Email_Address, Contact_Number, Loan_Type, Purpose_Of_Loan, and the Creator application reference. Use the protected connection when calling the CRM API.

Step 9: Store the CRM record identifier and synchronization status in a protected integration log or related record. Do not expose raw access tokens or full API responses to applicants.

Phase E: Test and Diagnose

- Submit a valid loan enquiry and confirm that one CRM record is created.
- Repeat the workflow callback for the same application and confirm that duplicate handling is controlled.
- Test missing email or phone values according to the mapping policy.
- Test expired authorization, CRM validation failure, throttling, and service unavailability.
- Confirm that the Creator application record is retained even when CRM synchronization fails.

3. Output

3.1 Zoho Creator Microservices Workspace

The Microservices workspace provides the entry point for creating connections, data sources, AI components, and custom APIs.

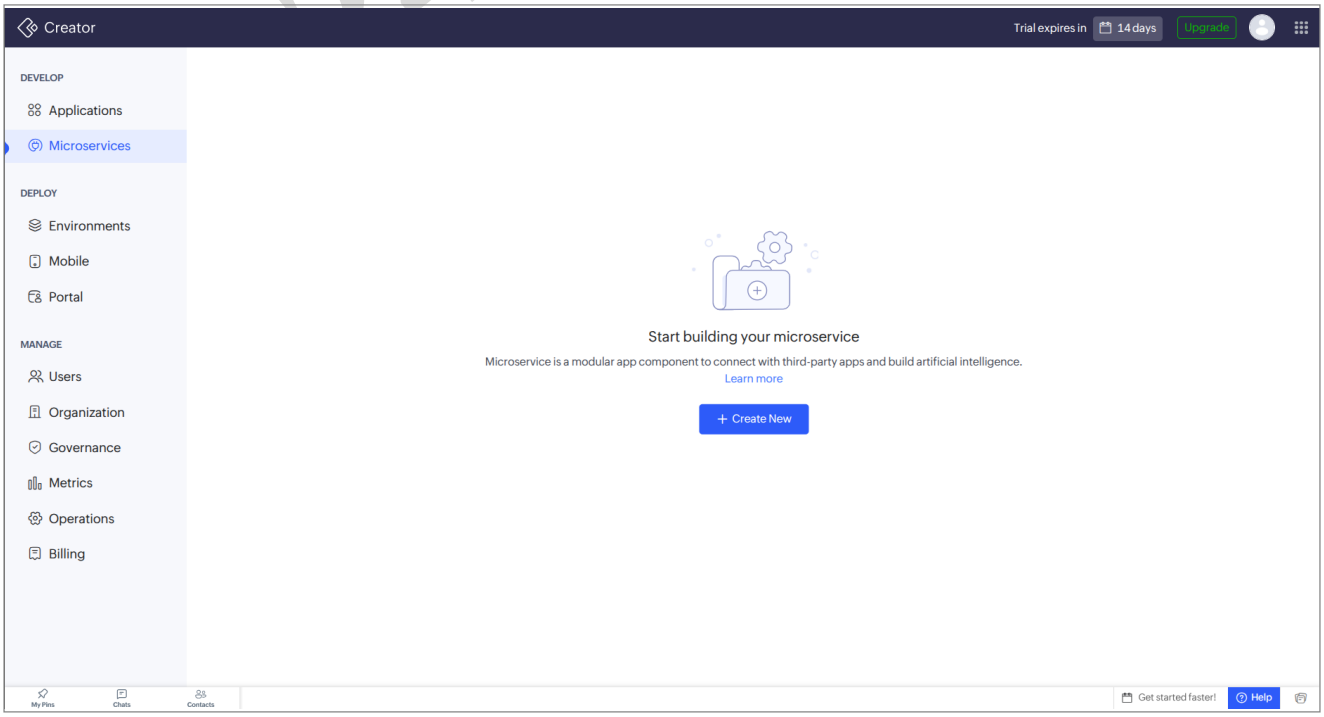


Figure 1: Zoho Creator Microservices management console

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3.2 Select the Connection Component

The Create New Microservice palette is used to select a Connection for authenticated communication with the target Zoho service.

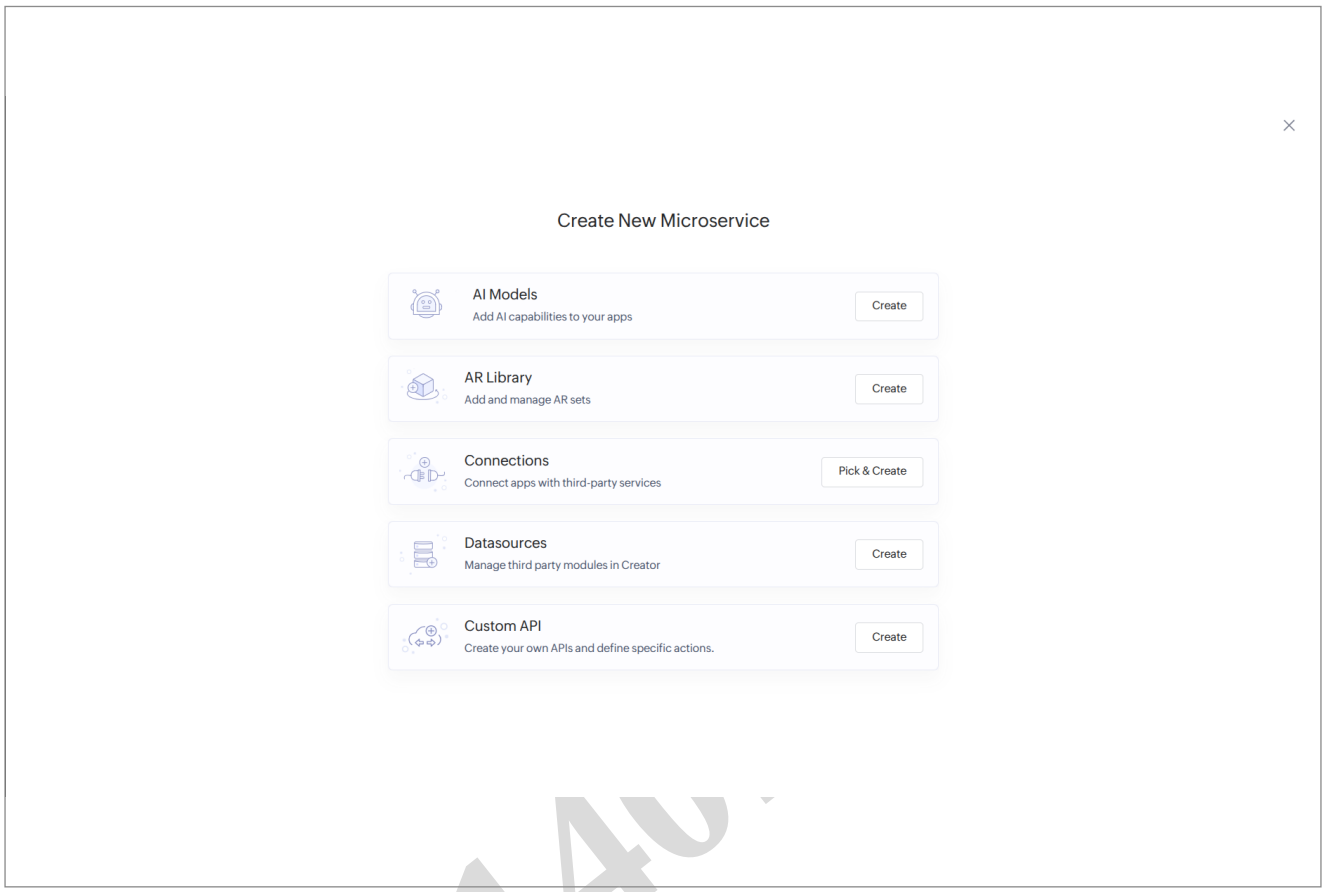


Figure 2: Selecting Connections from the microservice component palette

Loan Integration Boundary

The connection provides authentication and an approved access scope. The form workflow remains responsible for validating the loan enquiry, constructing the minimum payload, processing the response, and recording a retryable synchronization status.

Layer	Responsibility
Loan_Application_Form	Collect and validate the thirteen Basic Fields
Workflow	Select permitted fields and invoke the connection
Connection	Provide managed authorization to the CRM API
CRM	Create the loan-enquiry lead and return an identifier

3.3 Built-in Connector Catalog

The connector catalog lists native Zoho services, including Bigin and Zoho CRM.

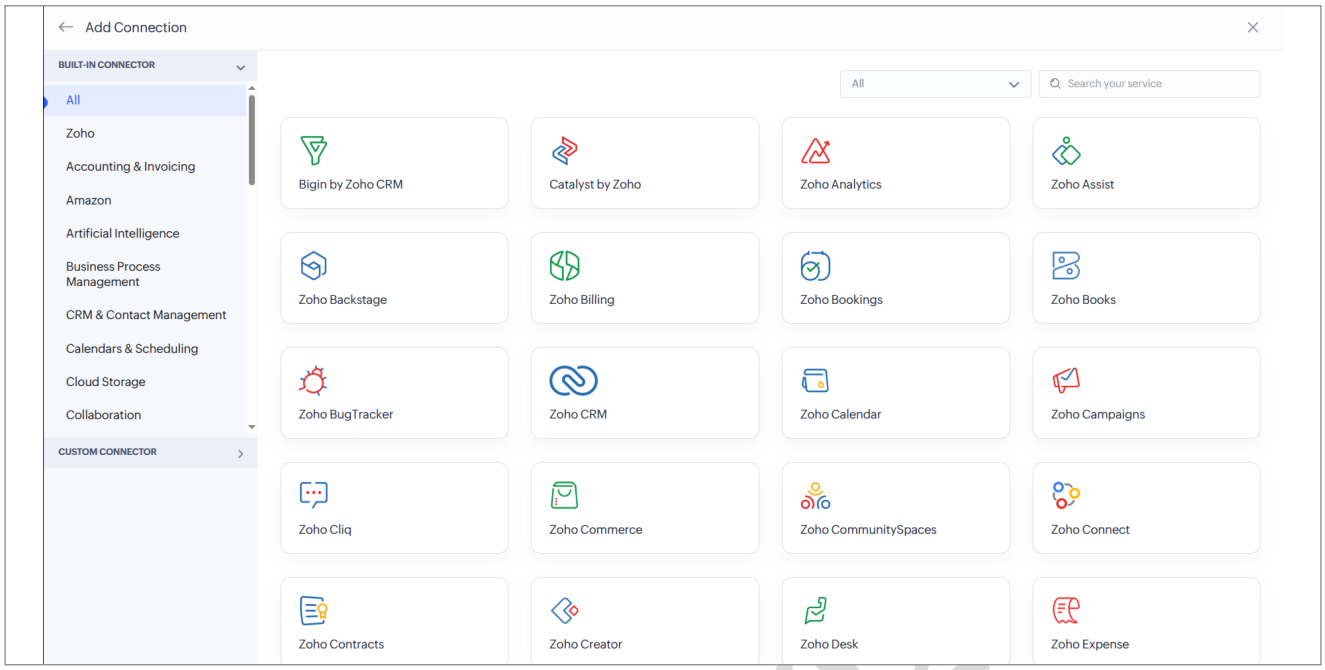


Figure 3: Built-in Zoho connector catalog

3.4 Connection Authorization

The authorization drawer defines the connection name, authorized users, connection mode, and scopes. For the loan workflow, use the narrowest scopes that satisfy the selected CRM operation.

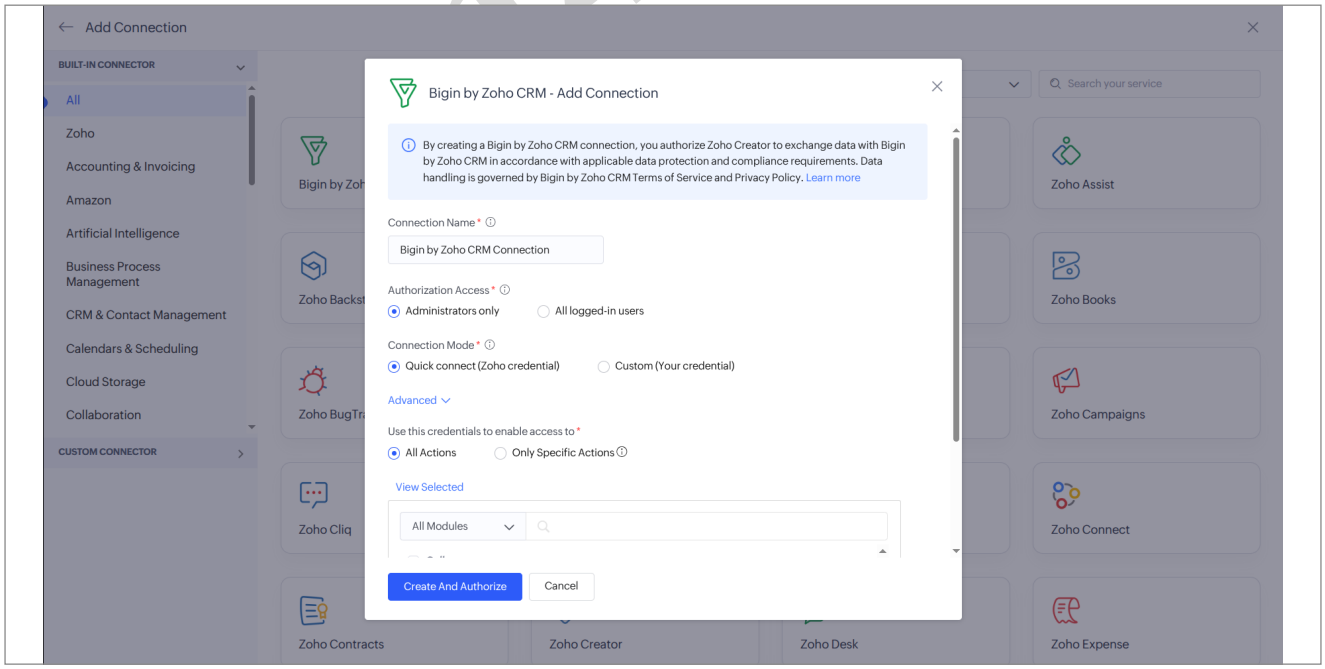


Figure 4: Connection authorization and access-scope configuration

3.5 Loan Enquiry Field Mapping

Creator source	CRM destination	Purpose	Example
Applicant_Name.first_name	First_Name	Applicant contact	Suresh
Applicant_Name.last_name	Last_Name	Applicant contact	Raghavan
Email_Address	Email	Acknowledgement and follow-up	suresh.raghavan@example.com
Contact_Number	Phone	Loan officer callback	+91 94430 22110
Loan_Type	Lead interest / custom field	Route enquiry by product	Home Loan
Purpose_Of_Loan	Description	Summarize stated requirement	Home renovation and furniture
Creator record reference	External_ID / custom field	Idempotency and traceability	LA-EXAMPLE-001
Static literal	Lead_Source	Identify originating channel	Zoho Creator Loan Portal

Excluded by default: PAN_Number, Date_Of_Birth, Residential_Address, Monthly_Income, Existing_Liabilities, and Consent_For_Credit_Check. Add any of these only after privacy review, a documented purpose, and suitable CRM field-level access controls.

4. Result / Observations

1. A connection-based design links a valid loan application submission to a CRM enquiry without embedding credentials in Deluge code.
2. A minimal payload supports lead routing and applicant follow-up while reducing unnecessary transfer of identity and financial data.
3. The Creator record reference provides a key for duplicate control, reconciliation, and troubleshooting.
4. Success requires verification of the CRM response and stored record identifier; a successful form submission alone does not prove synchronization.
5. Failures should be logged for authorized review and retry while preserving the original Loan_Application_Form record.

The retained screenshots document the generic connection-creation workflow from the supplied PDF. Record the actual loan-application connection name, approved scopes, test responses, and CRM record identifiers after performing the integration in the current Zoho account.

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